

UP men, Kerala women triumph



Uttar Pradesh (men) and Kerala (women) emerged champions in the inaugural National Under-23 3x3 Basketball Championships at the Regional Sports Centre in Kochi.

Powered by three internationals, Uttar Pradesh overcame a late surge from host Kerala to win the men's final 21-14. In the women's final, Kerala registered a comfortable 19-11 victory over Karnataka.

Kushal Singh, who featured in the 3x3 Asia Cup in Singapore in March, starred for UP with 11 points, helping his team take an early lead. Kerala closed the gap to 14-17 with a minute and a half remaining, but UP pulled away to seal the win.

The women's final was a dominant team effort, with Akshaya Philip, Chinnu Koshy, and Ann Mary Zachariah standing out.

"They're good outside shooters, so we focused more on defence," said Kerala captain Akshaya.

Both winning teams received a cash prize of Rs 3 lakh.

The results:

Men's final: Uttar Pradesh 21 (Kushal Singh 11) bt Kerala 14 (Aaron Varghese 6). Third place: Tamil Nadu bt Telangana 16-15.

Semifinals: Kerala bt Tamil Nadu 21-10; Uttar Pradesh bt Telangana 19-17.

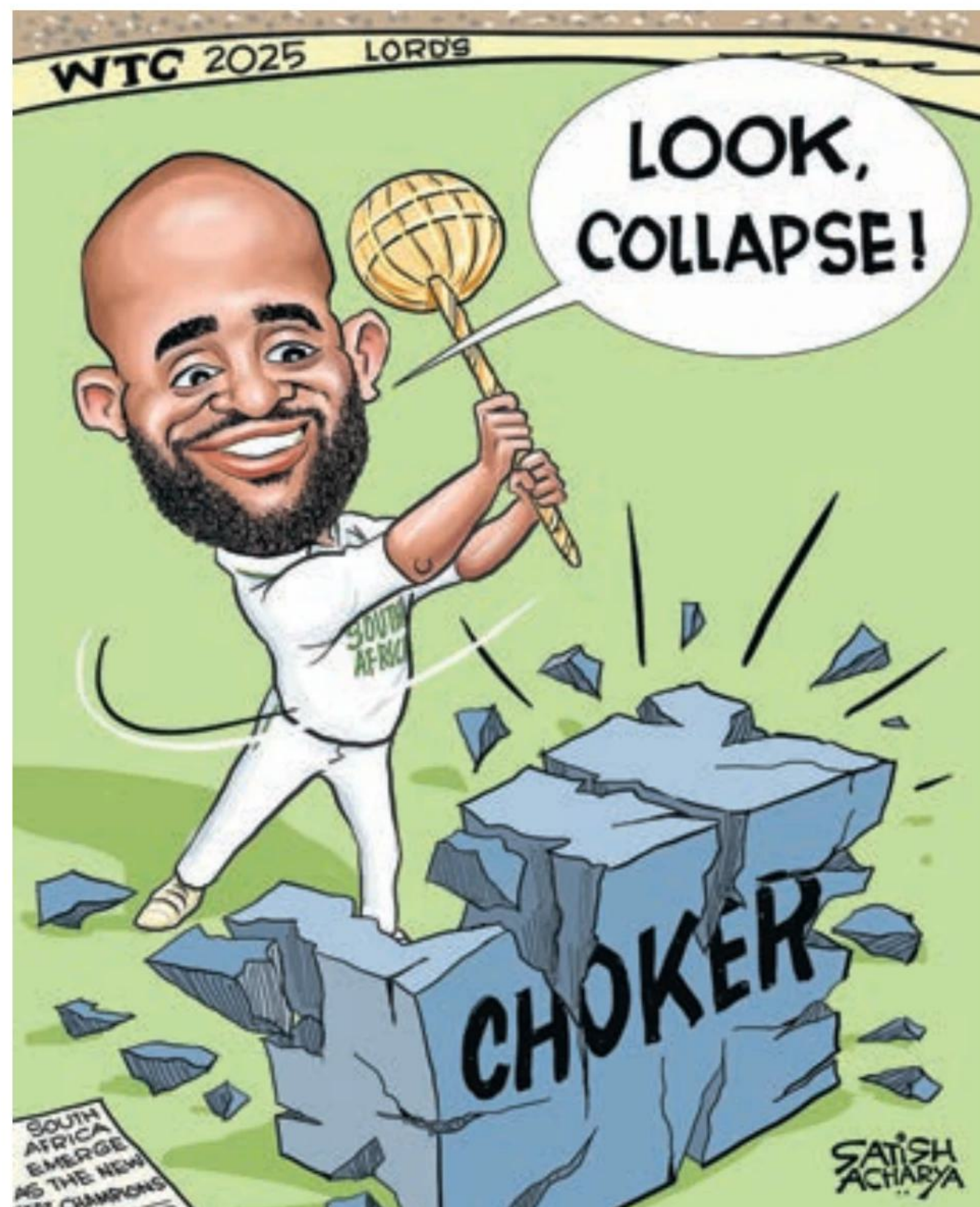
Women's final: Kerala 19 (Chinnu Koshy 6, Akshaya Philip 5, Ann Mary Zachariah 5) bt Karnataka 11. Third spot: Maharashtra bt Haryana 18-14.

Semifinals: Kerala bt Maharashtra 16-9; Karnataka bt Madhya Pradesh 21-19.



UP men and Kerala women, the winners. R. K. NITHIN

SPORTOON



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